

NE.3 Inspection Sequence

One inspection track the statute fixes, two registrations that stand in for the rest — and what to do where nobody is required to inspect you.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Nebraska adopts one state building code and then makes enforcing it optional: the code is "the legally applicable code regardless of whether the county, city, or village has provided for the administration or enforcement" of it, no county or city has to issue a building permit, and no state agency may inspect a private house. What does not depend on any of that: the **state electrical inspection**, enforced at the power meter; the **energy code**, which you build to yourself; and the **septic and well filings**, which are made by the professional or by you. Confirm every item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it. The electrical sequence below is statutory and applies on every parcel in the state. Everything else is local: where your city or county runs a building program its schedule governs, and where it does not, no building inspection is required of you by anyone.

WHAT YOU GET DEPENDS ON WHO RUNS A PROGRAM

NE.1 established that the code binds your house either way. Here is what that means once the concrete starts moving. **Read down the electrical column.** It is the same in both rows, and that is the point almost every Nebraska owner-builder misses.

Two situations, one electrical answer

Where you are	Who does the BUILDING inspections	Who does the ELECTRICAL inspections
A city or county building program exists	The local department inspects, on its own adopted code — which may be newer than the state's — and its own schedule. Ask for the list; write it on the log at the end	Inspected. By the local certified inspector if the city or county runs its own electrical program, otherwise by the State Electrical Division — the two do not always line up
No building program	Nobody. No building permit, no footing or framing inspection, no certificate of occupancy — and no state agency may step in. The 2018 IRC and UPC bind the house anyway	Inspected. Still required. The State Electrical Division, at temporary service, rough-in and final, and the power company holds the meter until you certify the request was filed

The building side rests on the Building Construction Act, § 71-6406(7) ("may adopt ... inspections"). The electrical side rests on a different act entirely — the State Electrical Act, § 81-2124(3) (every new single-family service is inspected) and § 81-2125(1) (state inspection yields only to a county, city or village that inspects with its own certified inspector by ordinance). The two lists of jurisdictions are not the same, which is why NE.4 sends you to the Division's map rather than to the county.

THE ELECTRICAL TRACK — THE ONE SEQUENCE THE STATUTE FIXES

This is unusual: a genuine statutory response time, a concealment rule with a cost attached, and a correction-order window with dates. The Division's homeowner handout adds the practical shape — temporary service, new service, rough-in, final, re-inspection — and the two agree.

Neb. Rev. Stat. § 81-2134 — state inspection procedures, verbatim

"(1)(a) At or before commencement of any electrical installation which is required by law to be inspected, the person responsible for the installation shall forward a request for inspection to the board completed in the manner prescribed by the board ...

(2) Where wiring is to be concealed, **the inspector must be notified within reasonable time to complete a rough-in inspection prior to concealment**, exclusive of Saturdays, Sundays, and holidays. If wiring is concealed before rough-in inspection without adequate notice having been given to the inspector, **the person responsible for having enclosed the wiring shall be responsible for all costs resulting from uncovering and replacing the cover material.**

(3) **Inspections shall be made within one week of the appropriate request.** When necessary, circuits may be energized by the authorized installer prior to inspection but the installation shall remain subject to condemnation and disconnection."

The electrical sequence, in the order it happens

	Step	What the statute and the Division say	Cite
1	File the request	"At or before commencement," with the fees, and — as a homeowner — the signed verification. Online since April 13, 2026; homeowner permits are linked by Division staff after you register. You receive a permit number and the inspector's details on the "yellow wiring permit card"	§ 81-2126; § 81-2134(1)
2	Temporary service	A separate application, "a minimum of five working days prior to the date energization is required"; the inspector "may verbally authorize energization." The handout: temporary services "WILL NOT be energized by the power company until they receive authorization to do so from the State Electrical Inspector"	Board Rule 12; handout
3	New service	The meter base, service entrance and panel. "When a permit is issued for the new service, the State Electrical Division office will forward a copy to the power supplier" — which is why the form asks for the supplier's name and address	Handout; § 81-2129
4	Rough-in	"Must be approved by the inspector before fiberglass insulation or drywall is installed." Notify "within reasonable time"; inspection within one week of the request; cover it first and you pay to uncover it	§ 81-2134(2)-(3); handout

The electrical sequence, in the order it happens

	Step	What the statute and the Division say	Cite
5	Final	After devices, fixtures and equipment are in. On approval the utility's liability for the installation "shall be terminated" — the reason the power company wants this done. Buy the \$6 written approval notice; it is your record	§ 81-2133
6	Correction, if any	For a defect that is not immediately dangerous the inspector issues a correction order "noting specifically what changes are required" and setting a final-inspection date "not less than ten nor more than seventeen calendar days from the date of the order." Uncorrected, "a condemnation or disconnection order may be issued." The handout allows "approximately fourteen working days to make the corrections"	§ 81-2138; handout
7	The meter	No connection "until there is filed with the electrical utility supplying power a certificate of the property owner ... that inspection has been requested and that the conditions of the installation are safe for energization." The supplier "may refuse service without liability" until it is	§ 81-2129

Handout quotations are from the State Electrical Division's Homeowner Handout, updated May 22, 2024, at electrical.nebraska.gov/homeowner-handout. Requests for an inspection go to the inspector named on your permit card, who has a 24-hour voicemail line: "State your name, your telephone number, your permit number, and whether you" need a rough-in or a final. A dangerous defect skips the correction order: an unenergized installation is condemned (§ 81-2136), an energized one disconnected (§ 81-2137). Appeal is to the board, through a hearing officer (§ 81-2141-2142).

Three clocks on the permit itself, and the felony behind the first

Before you start. The request is due "at or before commencement" (§ 81-2126). If the board becomes aware you did not file, it sends a certified letter giving **fourteen days**; a late request carries a **\$250** delinquent fee; and failure to file within the fourteen days goes to the county attorney under § 81-2143 — which, since **July 18, 2026**, makes "fail[ing] to file a request for inspection when required" a **Class IV felony** (§ 81-2143(1)(c), as amended by LB889).

Five months. Under Board Rule 13 the permit is void if the work "has not been started within five (5) months after the date of" issuance, or if no progress is made for five consecutive months, after fourteen days' written notice. An extension takes "clear and convincing proof of a practical hardship." If your build stalls — financing, weather — write to the Division before the fifth month, not after.

Two knocks. Rule 13 also prescribes what happens when an inspector cannot reach "a property owner installing wiring pursuant to Sections 81-2121(5) and 81-2124": a doorknob notice card, a second attempt and a second card, and then the application "stays on file, subject to inspection." An unanswered card does not close the file; it leaves the house uninspected with a certificate on record at the utility that says otherwise — see § 81-2143(1)(a) on false statements.

THE TWO REGISTRATIONS THAT ARE ALSO YOUR INSPECTIONS

Nobody from the state comes to look at a septic system or a well on a private house. What the state requires instead is a **professional's signature on a registration** — and on a parcel with no building department, those two documents plus the electrical approval are the whole of your third-party record.

Four obligations, one inspector — you

	Who files, and when	What you keep	Cite
Septic	The certified professional, engineer or environmental health specialist who built or supervised the system registers it with DWEE "within forty-five days of completion," on DWEE's form, with the fee — and submits the signed certification, the scaled drawing and the perc data that make the general permit cover you	"[W]ill provide a copy of the system registration form to the system owner." Ask for it at completion , file it with the drawing, and note the reserve area on your site plan so nobody builds on it	§ 81-15,248(2); Title 124 ch. 10 § 004; GTS220000 § II.A
Well	Registered with DWEE "within sixty days after completion," with the well-log information, by the licensed driller — or by you if you drilled it. \$200 plus \$25-\$40	Keep the well log: "Any owner of a water well ... shall keep and maintain an accurate well log." If a driller did it, get the registration number and the log before the final payment	§ 46-602(1); § 46-1241; § 46-606(1)
Radon	Required by statute; no registration, no inspection, no form outside a local program. Nothing in the Act names an inspector	Photograph the vent pipe in the subslab material before the pour, the roof termination, the labels and the attic box. That is the only evidence the house will ever have	§ 76-3504
Energy	Required by statute; no permit, no certificate, no inspection on request. DWEE or a local code authority may inspect "only after permission has been granted by the owner or occupant or after a warrant has been issued"	Keep the REScheck report or component table, the insulation certificates, and the blower-door and duct-test results. The two-year correction window runs from first occupancy	§ 81-1617; § 81-1622; § 81-1625

WHERE A LOCAL PROGRAM EXISTS

No Nebraska statute lists the inspections a house gets. Where a city or county runs a program, the list is in its own administrative amendments adopted under § 71-6406(7) — "organization of enforcement ... examination of plans, inspections, appeals, permits, and fees" — and it varies.

The list below is typical of such programs and is not attributed to the state. Ask yours, and write its list on the log.

A typical local sequence — confirm yours

Inspection	Note
Footings — forms and reinforcing in place, before concrete	Often combined with a foundation-wall or slab inspection; a monolithic pour is usually inspected once
Underground plumbing and radon rough — before the slab	Where the program inspects plumbing at all; the UPC applies regardless, but nobody is obliged to inspect it
Framing with rough plumbing, mechanical and electrical	The state electrical rough-in may be a separate visit by a different inspector; do not assume one covers the other
Insulation	Where a local energy code exists; batts in before the visit, blown or sprayed insulation inspected before it goes in — ask which
Final and, where issued, a certificate of occupancy	No state rule requires a CO for a house. Ask whether the local program issues one, because a lender may ask for it

*Lincoln, verified from its own pages (September 2026): homeowner plumbing, mechanical and electrical permits "may only be issued to a licensed contractor or a homeowner for their primary residence"; "The permit issued must be inspected before any work is concealed and must also be inspected when the installation of the work is completed"; "Permits are valid for 120 days from issuances." **Virtual inspections** are now lawful for a one- or two-family house under § 71-6409 (effective July 18, 2026), conducted live with the permit holder and conditioned on naming a licensed or registered contractor "who is completing the work" — and "Authorized inspector does not include an individual performing a self-performed inspection for the individual's own permit or building." Ask whether your program offers it and whether it will extend it to owner-performed work.*

WHEN NOBODY IS REQUIRED TO INSPECT YOU

On a parcel with no building program there is no building permit, no required building inspection and no certificate of occupancy — and, unlike some states, **no state office you can ask to inspect voluntarily**: the Act gives no agency that power over a private house. What you have instead is the code, which binds you, and a record you build yourself.

The record you are building, and who will read it

The buyer's lender, the appraiser and the insurer will ask what the house was inspected to. Your answer is the electrical approval notice, the septic registration with its scaled drawing, the well registration and log, and the energy documentation — plus dated photographs at every stage that gets covered: footing steel, the radon pipe in the subslab material, underground plumbing, framing and rough-ins, insulation. Keep them together, and keep the emails in which the county told you no permit was required.

The state, for two years. If DWEE or a local code authority "finds, within two years from the date a building is first occupied, that the building, at the time of construction, did not comply with the Nebraska Energy Code," it "may order the owner or prime contractor to take those actions necessary to bring the building into compliance" (§ 81-1625). And "a building owner may submit a written request that the department undertake a determination" (§ 81-1616) — a path a later buyer holds. Your blower-door result is the document that answers it.

The seller-disclosure statement you will sign when you sell an occupied house is "to the best of the seller's belief and knowledge" — and the person who built the house knows more than most sellers. The inspection log below is what you will be disclosing from.

And the electrical inspections happen anyway. Whatever your county decided about building codes, a State Electrical Division inspector — or the city's — will come out at temporary service, rough-in and final. That is not optional, the power company enforces it, and it is the one visit every Nebraska house gets.

INSPECTION LOG — RECORD EVERY ONE

Every visit and every filing, whoever required it

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Electrical request for inspection filed — before any wiring began — with the homeowner verification. Date _____ Permit number _____ Inspector _____		
☐	Temporary service — application five working days ahead; inspector's authorization to energize. Date _____ Inspector _____ Result _____		
☐	Footing / foundation — local program, if any; otherwise my own dated photographs of the steel before the pour. Date _____ Inspector _____ Result _____		
☐	Radon rough — vent pipe in the subslab material, sump lids, before the slab. Photographed. Date _____ By _____ Result _____		

Every visit and every filing, whoever required it

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Underground plumbing — to the 2018 UPC (or the city's code). Local program or photographs. Date _____ Inspector _____ Result _____		
☐	Electrical rough-in — state or local inspector, before insulation or drywall. Requested within reasonable time; due within one week. Requested _____ Inspected _____ Result _____		
☐	Framing, rough plumbing, rough mechanical — local program, if any; otherwise photographs. Date _____ Inspector _____ Result _____		
☐	Insulation — local energy code, if any; the certificates and R-values kept either way. Date _____ Inspector _____ Result _____		
☐	Blower door and duct test — under 3 ACH50; ducts $\leq$ 4 CFM per 100 sq ft unless all inside the envelope. Date _____ Tester _____ Result _____		
☐	Electrical final — approval notice (\$6) requested and received; correction order, if any, closed within its 10-17 days. Date _____ Inspector _____ Result _____		
☐	Certificate to the power supplier filed; meter set. Filed _____ Meter set _____		

Every visit and every filing, whoever required it

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Septic system registered by the professional within 45 days; my copy received. Registration _____ Copy received _____		
☐	Well registered within 60 days; well log in hand. Registration _____ Log received _____		
☐	Final building inspection / certificate of occupancy , where a local program issues one. Date _____ Number _____		
☐	Any inspection my local program requires that is not on this list — ask them, and write it here: Inspection _____ Date _____		

Every statute cited here is free to read at one address you can type:

nebraskalegislature.gov/laws/statutes.php?statute=81-2121 — swap in any section number, comma included (81-15,248). Each page ends with a **Source** line naming every session law that touched it and, after a recent change, an **Effective Date** line. Read that line before you rely on the section. The rules are PDFs: Title 124 (septic) and Title 134 (wells) at **dwee.nebraska.gov**, the electrical Board rules at **electrical.nebraska.gov/statutes-rules**. **One warning:** the Board's rules PDF (April 2024) still calls an unfiled request for inspection a misdemeanor. Since July 18, 2026 the statute says felony. The statute wins. Read September 2026.